

Change Management Communications

Step 4 · Solution Design

Plans users, UAT, communications, training, feedback loops, and resistance handling, started in Step 4, not at launch. This example shows the communications component; user impact and training are documented separately in the Change Impact Assessment and training plan.

How to use this

Consistency matters as much as repetition. If the specific numbers or scope shift between messages, that inconsistency reads as uncertainty even when no one names it. State what the tool will not do, as clearly as what it will; unmet expectations, not the change itself, are what usually drive negative reactions after launch.

Example: State University's plan

Communications, by phase

Phase	Message	Channel
Engage / Discovery	"We're looking at how document review works today, before anything is built." Why now, and what role counselors will have in shaping it.	Team meeting, sponsor message
Build (before launch)	"Starting [date], when an application fails validation, the system flags it and sends the applicant a reason code automatically. Here is what changes for you, and what does not."	Team briefing, job aid, FAQ
Launch and after	Weekly: "Here's this week's exception volume and what the pattern tells us." Consistent numbers, no shifting counts.	Office hours, champion check-ins, dashboard link

Resistance response plan

Signal	Likely cause	Response
Low active usage	Trust gap, or the workflow doesn't fit real cases yet.	Investigate specific cases, not aggregate blame. Fix the friction, don't just re-announce the tool.
Workaround usage above 10%	The new process is harder than the old one, for some or all cases.	Identify which cases; fix design gaps in the next sprint or document the exception path clearly.
Minimal engagement after training	Training gap, not a motivation problem.	Pair with a champion for one real task; group training rarely transfers to individual confidence alone.